

SENATE RESOLUTION 31

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Grace Bolton Freeman
of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Grace Bolton Freeman; and

WHEREAS, Grace Freeman was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on December 20, 1932, in Pontotoc, Mississippi, Grace Olivia Bolton Freeman was the daughter of Richard Bolton and Carrie Pinson Bolton; and

WHEREAS, Grace Freeman was educated in the Pontotoc school system, where she excelled academically, and graduated from Pontotoc Colored High School before continuing her studies at Mississippi Industrial College (MIC) in Holly Springs, Mississippi; and

WHEREAS, at MIC, she played basketball and was elected Homecoming Queen before receiving her undergraduate degree in elementary education and embarking on a career as an educator in the Pontotoc County School System; and

WHEREAS, in 1957, she met and married the love of her life, Wiley H. Freeman, and the couple relocated to Memphis, where Mrs. Freeman served as a teacher with Memphis City Schools; and

WHEREAS, entering the banking industry, Grace Freeman enjoyed a long and storied career as a highly respected banking officer with Union Planters National Bank, where she remained a dedicated officer until her retirement in 1986; and

WHEREAS, a woman of deep and abiding faith, she was a longtime member of Mt. Pisgah C.M.E. Church, where she served as a member of Usher Board #1 and the Mary Becton Missionary Society; and

WHEREAS, she had a passion for gardening, especially growing tomatoes, okra, and peppers, and found great joy in baking; she was known far and wide for her delicious cakes; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Freeman was also deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Freeman was the proud mother of Richard U. Freeman, Sedgwick (Wendy) Freeman, Whitney Freeman, Carole Woodard, and Mary Freeman, the loving grandmother of Dr. Jonathan Freeman, Cordell Gray, Loren Freeman, Zachary (Hydeia) Freeman, and Marcus (Rebecca) Woodard, and the great-grandmother of six great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, she will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by her sister-in-law, Ludean Freeman, and a host of nieces and nephews, extended family members, and dear friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her husband and her parents, Mrs. Freeman was preceded in death by her brother, Richard Bolton, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Grace Freeman leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Grace

Bolton Freeman, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Freeman.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.